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Verizon SuperPages

Report of Evidence of Use

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Patent Number: US7953416B2

Claim Number: (1)

52. A process for dynamic routing of customer contacts to service providers via a telephone, comprising the steps of: establishing accounts for a plurality of service providers that provide non-telephonic -based services; permitting the plurality of service providers to bid against one another for a live telephone call based on a customer per-contact charge; creating a contact list comprised of the service providers ranked from the highest bidder service provider to the lowest bidder service provider; receiving a live telephone contact from a customer; routing the live telephone contact from the customer for a live conversation with the highest ranked bidder service provider on the contact list; and charging the service provider account receiving the live telephone contact the customer per-contact amount bid by the service provider.

Element 1:

52. A process for dynamic routing of customer contacts to service providers via a telephone, comprising the steps of:

Verizon's Superpages (yellow pages) provides a generic category ad with a local phone number. The ad and number will be different for each listing category. The categories include plumbing, taxi, etc. Call to that number is re-directed to a local advertiser in that category. From the figure attached, it is evident that the routing of a customer call happens dynamically to a local advertiser.

Ref 1: http://www.superpages.com/about/pressrelease/123.php

Ref 2: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2MA5rt97IU

Ref 3: http://certifiedknowledge.org/blog/verizon-offers-pay-per-call-solution/

Supporting Evidence:

"Verizon yellow pages will include generic category ads with a local contact number," Laver explained. "The ad - and number - will be different for each listing category in which it appears: plumbers, lawyers, dentists, etc. Calls to that number will be forwarded to a local online advertiser in that category. This makes the static directory a dynamic advertising medium."

SuperPages.com Pay For Calls advertising will have minimums ranging from $2 to $6 per call, depending on the business category. Advertisers can increase their prominence and drive more calls by raising their bids.

Starting in September, SuperPages.com will begin selling the service through its local and national sales channels and will provide advertisers with full-service customer care.



Verizon has launched a PPCall solution, however, it is a bit different than the other offerings on the market.

Verizon is building static ads with static phone numbers. However, those wishing phone calls are still bidding in an auction style for those leads. Sound confusing? It's really not, it's just a different model.

Basically, Verizon is going to build ads that they determine have high call rates.

Element 2:

establishing accounts for a plurality of service providers that provide non-telephonic -based services;

References from Verizon do not directly mention the back-end technology used by them. However, the ad mentions the usage of dynamically selecting the advertiser to whom a customer call will be directed. It also mentions about a bidding system that is updated daily. Depending on the category of the generic ad, advertisers pay at least $2 to $6 per call, but Verizon has seen bids reach $10 or $15. Hence, it is evident that there must be an online system present in the back-end which requires the advertisers to create online profiles for dynamic bidding per day. The references also mentions that the Verizon system is similar to Google Adwords which also require advertisers to create their online profile. However, please note that these are indicative references only.

Also, from the refence it is also clear that the servcies that is being advertised is related to plumbing, florists, etc, which are non-telephonic based services.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/ns/business-us_business/t/verizon-launches-google-like-advertising-model/#.V2PBKrt96Ul

Supporting Evidence:

NEW YORK — Google Inc. needed just five years to build a business with more than $6 billion in annual revenue, thanks to a cutting-edge advertising model where merchants bid for ad placement and only pay if someone clicks on their ad.

Now, Verizon Communications Inc. is bringing a similar model to a staid corner of the advertising business: the printed "Yellow Pages."

"For example, a restaurant would have a much lower bid than, say, a mortgage company, because their return is much higher on those calls," Rose said.

Depending on the category, businesses pay at least $2 to $6 per call, but Verizon has seen bids reach $10 or $15.

For the printed SuperPages, eStara keeps track of what companies a consumer calls through the generic numbers. If a consumer calls the "Taxi" number for the first time and is connected to, for instance, Cambridge Coach, Estara will route subsequent calls by that consumer to Cambridge Coach even if it is no longer the high bidder for the number.

Element 3:

permitting the plurality of service providers to bid against one another for a live telephone call based on a customer per-contact charge;

Multiple references suggest that the local advertiser to whom a customer originated call is being routed depends on who is the highest bidder for that particular day for that particular number. Hence, it is evident that multiple local advertisers bid against each other.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2MA5rt97IU

Ref 2: http://certifiedknowledge.org/blog/verizon-offers-pay-per-call-solution/

Ref 3: https://www.searchenginejournal.com/verizon-testing-pay-per-call-in-print-yellow-pages/3257/

Supporting Evidence:

Basically, Verizon is going to build ads that they determine have high call rates.
Those wishing the phone calls will bid (like PPC) for those calls.
Depending on who is the highest bidder at the time of the call, Verizon will route the call to that bidder.

What this does is take the complexity of building ads, testing call rates, etc out of the hands of the advertisers. The only complexity left for the advertiser is the actual budget and bidding.

Verizon will take on the responsibility of optimizing the ads, showing them in various appropriate locations, and just pass the phone call to the highest bidder.

Verizon Testing Pay Per Call in Print Yellow Pages

Verizon is taking a page from the Search Engine Marketing handbook and applying it to the traditional Yellow Pages as Pay Per Call ad auctions are sending phone calls to the top paying bidder in the Boston Area.

Peter Svensson of the AP has covered how Boston's SuperPages are giving top print Yellow Pages space to a generic ad which lists a local phone number. The caller is then connected to whichever business is paying Verizon top dollar for those calls. Calls are averaging about $3 each with some bids topping off at $15.

"One of our challenges, of course, with the print medium, is that once it's printed, it's there for a year," Rose said. "By doing this, there's actually an update daily of who will receive the calls based on the top daily bid."

Depending on the category, businesses pay at least $2 to $6 per call, but Verizon has seen bids reach $10 or $15.

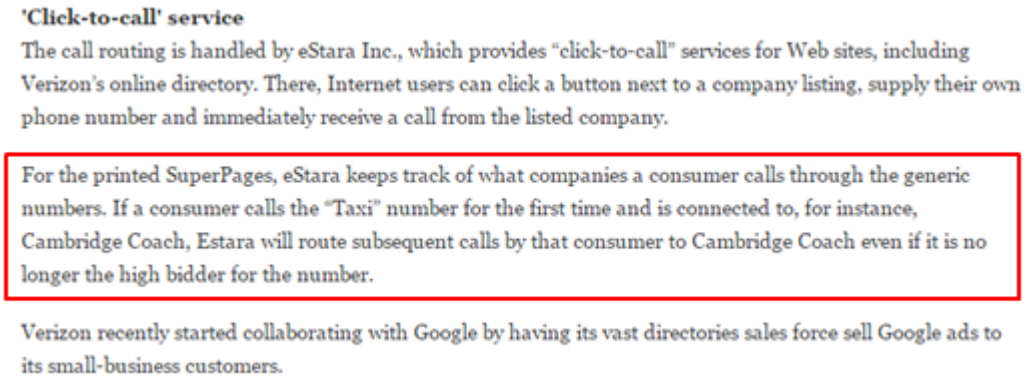
Element 4:

creating a contact list comprised of the service providers ranked from the highest bidder service provider to the lowest bidder service provider;

One of the references states that the call routing in Verizon SuperPages generic ad, is handled by eStara Inc., which provides "click-to-call" services for Web sites, including Verizon's online directory. The reference also states how a eStara keeps track of what companies a consumer calls through the generic numbers. If a consumer calls the "Taxi" number for the first time and is connected to, for instance, Cambridge Coach, Estara will route subsequent calls by that consumer to Cambridge Coach even if it is no longer the high bidder for the number. This gives an indication that a list of service providers is created in the back-end, where the list also contains their bid for that particular generic ad.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2PRd7t96Ul

Supporting Evidence:



'Click-to-call' service

The call routing is handled by eStara Inc., which provides "click-to-call" services for Web sites, including Verizon's online directory. There, Internet users can click a button next to a company listing, supply their own phone number and immediately receive a call from the listed company.

For the printed SuperPages, eStara keeps track of what companies a consumer calls through the generic numbers. If a consumer calls the "Taxi" number for the first time and is connected to, for instance, Cambridge Coach, Estara will route subsequent calls by that consumer to Cambridge Coach even if it is no longer the high bidder for the number.

Verizon recently started collaborating with Google by having its vast directories sales force sell Google ads to its small-business customers.

Element 5:

receiving a live telephone contact from a customer;

The generic number provided on the Verizon Superpages ad is the number that a customer calls to get a service like taxi service, locksmiths etc. Estara handles the call routing of the generic number ads provided by Verizon.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2MA5rt97IU

Ref 2: http://certifiedknowledge.org/blog/verizon-offers-pay-per-call-solution/

Ref 3: https://www.searchenginejournal.com/verizon-testing-pay-per-call-in-print-yellow-pages/3257/

Supporting Evidence:



If you call the local number attached to it, the cab company to which you end up speaking depends on when you're calling: The one paying Verizon the most on a given day will be the one answering.

Element 6:

routing the live telephone contact from the customer for a live conversation with the highest ranked bidder service provider on the contact list; and

Multiple references indicate that Estara handles the call routing of generic number ad by Verizon. Also, as per Robyn Rose, vice president of Internet marketing for Verizon Superpages.com, call to the generic ad number is routed to a highest bidder for that ad for that particular day.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/#.V2MA5rt97IU

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Those wishing the phone calls will bid (like PPC) for those calls.
Depending on who is the highest bidder at the time of the call, Verizon will route the call to that bidder.

If you call the local number attached to it, the cab company to which you end up speaking depends on when you're calling: The one paying Verizon the most on a given day will be the one answering.

In fine print, the taxi ad notes it is "dynamically assigned." Similar ads in the directory are for travel agencies and locksmiths.

If you call the local number attached to it, the cab company to which you end up speaking depends on when you're calling: The one paying Verizon the most on a given day will be the one answering.

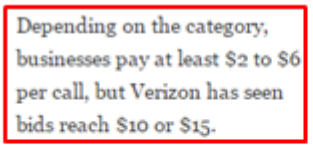
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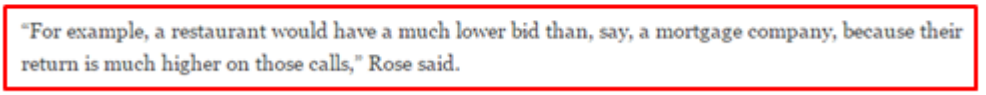
charging the service provider account receiving the live telephone contact the customer per-contact amount bid by the service provider.

Verizon's system charges the advertiser to whom the call is being routed as per the bid amount selected by him.

Ref 1: http://www.nbcnews.com/id/12097632/ns/business-us_business/t/verizon-launches-google-like-advertising-model/#.V2PBKrt96Ul

Supporting Evidence:


Depending on the category, businesses pay at least $2 to $6 per call, but Verizon has seen bids reach $10 or $15.


"For example, a restaurant would have a much lower bid than, say, a mortgage company, because their return is much higher on those calls," Rose said.

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We are available to answer follow up questions, provide clarifications and search for additional materials upon request. For public contact - please refer to our profile at ClaimCharts.info. For private contact - please call/email us.

Our hourly rate is: $

Non-Disclosure Agreement:

We understand that for the purpose of assisting you in collecting data, you may disclose to us certain confidential information that you want to keep confidential; therefore, for good and valuable consideration, the receipt and sufficiency of which is hereby acknowledged, we agree as follows:

1. For a period of twelve (36) months from the date we receive your confidential information ("Effective Date"), we will not use or disclose the information, except: (a) in the event that such information (i) comes into the public domain not through us; (ii) is already known to us at the time of disclosure; (iii) is lawfully otherwise learnt or independently developed by us; or (iv) is required to be disclosed by law.

2. Since a breach of our obligations hereunder may result in irreparable harm to you, we agree that upon such breach or threat thereof, you shall be entitled to specific performance and other injunctive relief without posting a bond, and in the event of disclosures required by court order, we shall promptly notify you of the proceeding.

3. This agreement supersedes all prior discussions and writings and constitutes the entire agreement between you and us with respect to the subject matter hereof. This Agreement shall be binding upon the successors and assigns of the respective parties, and may not be modified except by an instrument executed by both parties.

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